MODEL OF AGILITY



On a recent tour of Bihar's Samastipur division, railways minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** found himself at Karpoori Gram station, a modest halt with a ground-level platform. To help the minister board the train, officials went an extra mile: a decorated step-up stool and a phalanx of officers. Fitness enthusiast that he is, Vaishnaw waved it away and hopped on to the coach without any help. But not without first remarking, "So many officers deployed for just one step, something common passengers never get." Message received, one hopes.



Goodbye CBI?

The Bengal BJP's long-running romance with the CBI seems to be over. At a recent press meet, Asansol MLA **Agnimitra Paul** declared that the party now prefers the state police—the same force the BJP constantly accuses of toeing the Trinamool line—to probe the recent Kasba rape case. Reason? The CBI's "unsuccessful" efforts in the RG Kar Hospital case. And even as a gleeful TMC pounced ("So, your favourite agency failed?", asked one digital taunt), the BJP scrambled for damage control, labelling Paul's remarks as her "personal views".

JAB AND PARRY



A Covid vaccine debate drew Karnataka CM **Siddaramaiah** and Biocon chairperson **Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw** into a duel on X last week. It started with the government probe into the spate of sudden heart attack deaths in Hassan district, which Sidda suggested on X could be due to "hasty" approvals for Covid vaccines. Mazumdar-Shaw called out the "factually incorrect" comment and asked the CM to not spread "misinformation". The latter fired back, saying: "Seeking clarity is not misinformation." But before the week was out, the matter appeared settled, with the probe panel concluding that the jabs weren't linked to the deaths.

Kaushik Deka with Avaneesh Mishra, Avishek G. Dastidar, Jeemon Jacob, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar and Ajay Sukumaran

HEALTH WATCH

WHAT TO DO IF YOU GET DENGUE

By **Sonali Acharjee**

The rainy season is here, and so are the mosquitoes and the fear of dengue fever. The seasonal ailment has been flagged by the WHO as one of the top 10 global health threats. The fever usually lasts a week or so, and symptoms include rashes, body ache and nausea. The point of concern is that, in rare cases, there is a risk of complications developing that could result in internal haemorrhaging (in severe cases, even death). Doctors should be informed immediately if there is bleeding from the gums, abdominal pain, blood in stools or vomit, acute exhaustion or diarrhoea.



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If dengue is confirmed, a low blood platelet count is a common worry. Platelets, the smallest components of your blood, are needed for blood clotting. From papaya leaf extracts to herbal teas to vitamin supplements, the internet and well-meaning relatives are full of advice on how to keep platelet count up. This year is no different, say doctors. However, when it comes to controlling dengue, the secret is to stay calm and consult a doctor. This is because dengue will, regardless of what you do, reduce platelets. The virus affects our bone marrow's ability to make platelets. It is important for patients to let doctors decide if and when a transfusion is needed.

Other things are also important. Dr Sushila Kataria, veteran infectious diseases expert at Medanta, Gurugram, says hydration and rest are crucial for recovery. Gastric health must be taken seriously. An easy-to-digest diet, drinking plenty of fluids, mental and physical rest, reporting symptoms properly to doctors and not indulging in self-medication are still the time-tested best practices to avoid a serious case of dengue.